

Groww “Start Here” for the Gen Z Investor

MVP & post-MVP plan for the concept webapp · 7 October 2026 · Based on the brief “Designing Groww for the Gen Z Investor”

Goal: make the first investing experience simple, understandable and less intimidating for Indian 20–26-year-old first-time investors. We are building a polished, clickable **demo webapp** (a feature inside Groww, not a redesign) that runs the full journey end-to-end in about 5 minutes, using **real market data** and real logic, but **no real money**.



1. What we are doing in the MVP

Module	What the user does	How we build it	Guardrail
1. Gen Z onboarding	5 one-tap questions (goal, experience, monthly comfort, reaction to a dip, horizon), then names a goal	Rules table maps answers → persona (Steady Starter / Curious Explorer / Goal Saver) + a 3-step path	No risk score, no KYC up front
2. Bite-sized learning	3 lessons × 5 swipeable cards + 1 quiz each; tap terms like NAV for a 30-second explainer	Lesson content as validated JSON; card player with swipe; glossary bottom sheet	Plain language; finishing lesson 1 unlocks Practice
3. Mock investing	Time Machine: replay a ₹100–2,000/month SIP on real past prices. Mock portfolio: ₹10,000 virtual cash to buy/sell	Pure SIP-replay and portfolio engine; delayed prices (last close / NAV); reflection prompt after first actions	No live prices (SEBI 2024); labelled “Virtual money · Not a prediction”
4. Micro investing	Start Small: ₹100 / ₹250 (Chhoti SIP) / ₹500 per month → pick SIP date → review → confirm (demo)	Suggested fund category (index or liquid) + “last 5 years” context from real data	Education, not advice; same output for same answers
5. Progress & milestones	Monthly SIP streak with 1 streak freeze, goal ring, 6 milestones, own reflection notes	Streak and milestones computed from SIP history; demo clock “+1 month” to show them live	Rewards consistency and learning, never trading
Share (pulled in early)	9:16 achievement card for Stories, share or download	Image generated server-side (next/og) from habit stats only	No ₹ amounts or returns on cards

2. How we are building it

Area	Decision
Stack	Next.js 16 + TypeScript, Tailwind + shadcn/ui, Motion (animation), TradingView lightweight-charts, Zustand (state), TanStack Query (data), Zod (validation); hosted free on Vercel
Market data	Stocks, Nifty 50 and gold ETF from Yahoo Finance; mutual-fund NAVs from mfapi.in (6 funds, codes verified). Fetched on the server, cached 15 min, with a committed 5-year snapshot as fallback so the demo never breaks
User data	Saved in the browser (no login, no database), so there is nothing that can expire before a reviewer opens the link. Safe reset if saved data is old or corrupt
Logic	All money, streak and milestone rules are pure functions with unit tests written first
Demo controls	Hidden panel (?demo=1 or tap logo 5×): reset, jump to persona, +1 month, +1 month (skip SIP)
Quality	~75 unit tests (Vitest) + 1 end-to-end phone-size test (Playwright) of the full journey

3. One-week build timeline

Day	Work	Output
1	Scaffold, theme, engine: dates, SIP replay, portfolio, streak, persona, milestones	Tested core logic
2	Market data layer + snapshot, API routes, saved app state	Real data with fallback
3	Groww shell, journey hub, demo panel, onboarding, lessons	Learn flow works
4	Practice: Time Machine + mock portfolio	Practice flow works
5	Invest (Start Small) + Progress hub	Invest and Build work
6	Share card, end-to-end test, README with demo script	Full journey tested
7	Polish, deploy to Vercel, rehearse the 5-minute demo	Live demo URL

4. Post-MVP: what we will do next

Phase	Feature	How we would build it	Guardrail
P1	Social achievement cards (fuller set: streaks, year-in-review "Wrapped")	Extend the existing card generator; more templates; shareable links with previews	Habit stats only; opt-in
P2	Referrals	Invite link from a milestone card; reward both sides with a lesson pack or streak freeze	No cash or trading rewards (draft SEBI ad code, Jun 2026)
P3	Personalised recommendations	Run through Groww's SEBI-registered entity; until then, personalise learning (next lesson, nudges) rather than products	Needs Investment Adviser rules; disclaimers; no "best fund" lists
P4	Deeper gamification	Learning tracks and levels, goal challenges, SIP step-up milestones, gentle monthly nudges	No leaderboards by returns, no confetti on trades, no streak guilt-tripping

Path from demo to real product (when Groww adopts it):

- **Accounts and sync:** Groww login; store progress server-side instead of only in the browser.
- **Real investing:** hand Start Small to Groww's existing SIP + UPI AutoPay flow, with KYC only at this step.
- **Licensed data:** replace Yahoo/mfapi with Groww's own market feed.
- **Analytics and experiments:** track the funnel below and A/B test lessons, nudges and the default amount.

5. How we will measure success

Stage	Metric
Activation	% who finish onboarding; % who finish lesson 1
Practice	% who run the Time Machine or make a mock buy
Conversion	Practice → first real SIP; time from sign-up to first SIP
Habit	SIPs still running after 3 / 6 months; streak freeze usage; SIP pauses vs cancellations
Health checks	Trades per user stay low; no rise in F&O/intraday adoption from this cohort

6. Compliance guardrails built into the design

- No real-time prices in mock investing; delayed or historical data only (SEBI, May 2024).
- Reward learning and consistency, never trade count or returns; no false urgency or loss-aversion copy.
- Fund suggestions are category education with past-performance disclaimers, not personal advice.
- Share cards and links never show rupee amounts or returns.

7. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Free data source fails or rate-limits during the demo	Automatic fallback to the committed 5-year snapshot
Yahoo data is unofficial / non-commercial	Fine for a demo; production uses Groww's licensed feed
Gamification drifts toward trading	Rules above; metrics watch trade frequency
Streak pressure when money is tight	Monthly (not daily) streak + one streak freeze for a skipped month